

More gadgets, more bins

The US government has made it mandatory for all air travellers to get gadgets such as laptops, cell phones, radios, pagers, music players, digital camera, etc, checked at the security. Travellers will have to place them in separate checkpoint security bins to be scanned with an X-ray.

Post 9/11, The Transportation Security Administration (TSA) started ordering travellers to place their laptops in these bins. However, ever since reports claiming that Al-Qaeda could use common electronic items carried by air travellers to hide weapons, every gadget is being checked.

Experts advice travellers to sync their devices and take backups, in case the gadgets get damaged.



snapshot

Nokia is tipped to capture more than **40 per cent** of the cell phone market in **2004** and should sell more than **203 million** units worldwide.

Source: Strategy Analytics

Club Nintendo

Nintendo, the popular Japanese video game maker has announced a new customer loyalty program called 'Club Nintendo'. The scheme has been compared to a frequent flyers programs. Sign up for the program and you will be awarded points every time you make a Nintendo software purchase. You can exchange these points for free gifts such as a limited edition control for the GameCube, which will not be commercially available. The company's president, Mr. Satoru

Iwata, is hopeful that the new program will help boost sales by increasing customer loyalty and improving brand value. Club Nintendo will be launched in Japan and the United States by the end of the year and hopes to have 3,00,000 to 5,00,000 users sign up for the program within the first year itself.

Nintendo will also return to selling simpler software for a larger audience of customers rather than constantly increasing the complexity of its games.

A Hundred-product launch

HP has decided to launch more than 100 products in anticipation of a competitive holiday shopping season that would begin shortly. The product launch covers the traditional strong points of the company such as imaging products and home computing products.

A noteworthy product is the HP Photosmart 7960 Photo Printer—a top-of-the-line industry level printer for quality photo printing; The



HP Scanjet 4600 'See-Thru' scanner that was launched is characterised by a radical ultra-thin vertical design for use in cramped conditions. The HP Photosmart Mobile camera allows you to create, edit and transfer images on the go. Another product launch of interest was the DVD Movie Writer dc3000 that allows you to transfer video from tape onto a disk easily, using the analog video capture facility.

quoteworthy

"We certainly would urge third parties who want to continue (hosting the MSN software) to contact us before October 15 when they will no longer be able to access the network"

Microsoft spokesman, Sean Sundwall. Microsoft is making it mandatory to upgrade to MSN Messenger 5, or higher and Windows Messenger 4.7.2009, or higher, that are not yet compatible with third-party multi-ple instant messenger clients

"Technology works well when used to help qualified and well-trained human beings. Technology can never replace the human being."

Issac Yeffet, the founder of Yeffet Security Consultants, an airline security firm, and former El-Al head of global security, stating that mere technology cannot improve airport security; the people manning the machines should be trained and equipped properly

tomorrow's technology

Analyse me

Cognitive computing looks at developing machines that accurately assess user intent, and learn from previous interactions. Researchers at the Sandia National Laboratories, USA, are working on developing a computer along with a software that could eventually think like a person. Earlier systems tend to work within logical processes, some-

thing that we humans don't always do. Later, the focus shifted to machines that could be considered as synthetic humans—those that looked at the more logical cognitive patterns as well as organic factors. Cognitive psychologist, Chris Forsythe, and his team then moved to looking at integrating robotics with models of human cognition, and realised

that the model could be used to create intelligent machines. Currently, the Sandia team is looking at 'extraordinarily perceptive techniques' with cognitive systems to aid analysts and critical decision makers in jobs that involve interpreting meaningful patterns based on large data volumes derived from diverse sources.

■ Microsoft releases warnings of critical Internet Explorer, MDAC flaws ■ Dell cuts prices of notebooks, desktops, servers and peripherals as well